

AI Shortlist

Conversation transcript and product decisions

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This PDF records the AI Shortlist conversation: the initial concept, agreed MVP scope, name and deployment decisions, architecture direction, user-experience work, and the important correction made after reviewing Green Gecko Gardens.

Core decision

A small Auckland business enters its domain, receives immediate value, then can buy a dated AI web-search report that tests the buyer questions which matter. It must never claim a fixed ChatGPT or OpenAI rank.

Chronological thread index

Every user turn in this AI Shortlist discussion is represented below. The following pages retain the detailed requirements and the substantive assistant responses.

- Initial photographed concept: a small-business AI discovery and reporting service.
- Entrepreneurial critique: why the first idea may be weak or hard to sell.
- Research questions on GEO, Google Scholar and checking a business's visibility in OpenAI/ChatGPT.
- First workflow: website and email supplied; infer three ICPs; create ten ICP searches; record results.
- Revised funnel: domain first, provide value, then request email and sell the full report.
- Request to scope the idea as requirements; question on whether it is an SDD; request for AI-development SDD advice.
- Full MVP requirements supplied and then updated.
- Requirement for a template that ChatGPT/model output populates.
- Naming exploration: five names; must include AI; must link to business revenue; choices for tradies and NZ small businesses.
- CustomerRadar considered and rejected as too close to an existing adjacent business.
- AI Shortlist selected and locked in.
- Deployment chosen: getaishortlist.successbycs.com.
- Architecture choice considered: Cloudflare or Vercel.
- User experience requested, then first results-screen and report mock-ups requested.
- Scenario set: Green Gecko Gardens domain entered; results webpage must show value and capture email.
- Free minimum-report email and paid Standard Report offer requested; then shortened.
- Green Gecko's project photos challenge: generic advice was rejected as inaccurate.
- Decision to test one buyer-style AI search in the free email and show the businesses surfaced.
- Request to insert the search result into the email mock-up.

Conversation milestones

USER

My idea: a business enters its website, AI understands what the business does, identifies likely customers and tests the searches those buyers might use.

ASSISTANT

The useful product is not a claimed AI rank. It is a dated sample of defined buyer questions, clear evidence and practical actions.

USER

The user enters a domain name, we provide value, then request their email and send a free report. Then seek payment for a full report.

ASSISTANT

Agreed journey: domain first; website assessment and preview immediately; email for the free snapshot; NZ\$47 paid report testing ten questions.

USER

Help me add requirements to scope this out. Is this an SDD? Review SDD best practices as they relate to AI development.

ASSISTANT

Treat the requirements as the product specification; add templates, prompt/data contracts, evidence rules, evaluation examples, failure states and clear acceptance criteria before building.

USER

We will need a template that ChatGPT populates.

ASSISTANT

Use fielded templates. The model supplies evidence-linked fields; a deterministic renderer produces the webpage, email and PDF. Do not let a model invent the report layout.

USER

Lock in AI Shortlist. We will deploy as getaishortlist.successbycs.com.

ASSISTANT

Identity locked: AI Shortlist by SuccessByCS, initially at getaishortlist.successbycs.com.

USER

Would we use Cloudflare or Vercel? Draw the user experience. Build a screen mock-up. Provide a mock-up of the report.

ASSISTANT

Recommended Cloudflare for the website/API, durable jobs, storage and administration; use a simple mobile-first journey, then templated reports.

MVP requirements agreed

AI Shortlist — MVP Requirements

Product identity

- Product name: **AI Shortlist**
- Initial public deployment: **getaishortlist.successbycs.com**
- Brand owner and support provider: **SuccessByCS**

1. Product purpose

AI Shortlist helps a small Auckland service business understand whether its public website makes it clear to AI-powered web search what it sells, who it serves, and where it operates.

The system infers likely buyer situations from public website content, creates realistic local questions those buyers may ask, and tests those questions with OpenAI web search using an Auckland location setting.

AI Shortlist does not provide an official OpenAI ranking and does not guarantee that a business will be recommended in ChatGPT or any other AI product.

2. Primary buyer

The first target buyer is an owner of a small Auckland residential landscaping or garden-maintenance business.

They are not SEO, GEO or AI experts. They want clear, practical evidence of whether their online presence is helping or costing them enquiries.

Future categories may include builders, plumbers, electricians and roofers. They are out of scope for the first MVP.

3. Core customer journey

Step 1: Domain entry

The first page asks only for:

- Website/domain name

Primary button: `Check my website`

Do not request an email address before showing useful value. Validate URLs, block private/internal network addresses, and rate-limit submissions.

Step 2: Website analysis

The system reads publicly accessible content from the submitted website and creates a structured assessment.

Extract or infer:

- business name
- business type and services
- apparent service area
- short website summary

- three likely buyer situations / ICP hypotheses
- supporting website excerpts for every ICP hypothesis
- evidence available on the website:
 - reviews/testimonials
 - project/case-study detail
 - team/owner identity
 - service locations
 - clear contact details
 - FAQs
 - pricing/quote guidance
 - credentials or memberships

If the website cannot be read, explain that the scan could not be completed. Create an admin alert. Invite the visitor to enter an email address if they would like a response from SuccessByCS.

Step 3: Immediate free preview

Show useful results immediately:

- “Here is how your website currently appears to describe your business”
- short business summary
- three likely buyer situations
- one example customer question
- three top visibility/trust gaps

Example buyer situations:

1. Henderson homeowner planning a garden renovation
2. New-build owner needing a complete landscape
3. Property owner needing retaining-wall work

Example customer question:

Find me a Henderson-based lawn-mowing company with good reviews.

Example gap:

There is limited detailed local project evidence that a customer—or AI-powered web search—can use to verify your experience.

Step 4: Email capture

After the preview, ask for:

- Email address — required to send the free report
- Optional, unchecked consent checkbox: “I’d also like occasional practical guidance from SuccessByCS.”

Button: `Send my free report`

Do not request passwords, email inbox access, Google Business Profile access or other private business data.

Step 5: Free email report

Send a concise SuccessByCS-branded email containing:

- website URL
- Auckland date and time
- website/business summary
- three likely buyer situations
- three example AI-search questions customers may ask
- three top opportunities
- a short description of the paid report

Primary CTA:

`See how AI search currently describes your business to your key buyers`

4. Paid product: AI Shortlist Report

Price for MVP: **NZ\$47 including GST**.

The paid report includes:

- ten predefined customer questions
- three questions for each identified buyer situation
- one comparison/recommendation question
- actual dated OpenAI web-search responses
- whether the business was:
 - recommended
 - mentioned
 - absent
 - described incorrectly
- competitors mentioned
- cited sources and complete source list where available
- prioritised actions across:
 - website clarity
 - website design, build and function
- Google Business Profile
- reviews
- local project proof
- FAQs
- service-area pages
- third-party trust signals

The report must state:

This report is an automated, dated sample of OpenAI web-search responses to defined customer questions using an Auckland location setting. It is not an official OpenAI ranking, and future results may vary.

5. Paid report workflow

1. Customer receives the free Minimum Report by email.
2. Customer buys the Full AI Shortlist Report through Stripe.
3. A successful Stripe webhook creates a paid report job with status `Paid`.
4. The job runs the ten approved questions using OpenAI web search with:
 - an Auckland location setting
 - required web search
 - saved prompt text
 - saved model/version
 - saved run date and time
5. The system stores the answer, citations, full source list, competitor mentions and run time.
6. The system generates a SuccessByCS-branded PDF from the paid report template.
7. The customer receives an email with a secure report link and PDF attachment.
8. A failed job is marked for human review and the customer is notified.

Service promise:

Usually delivered within 10 minutes; within 24 hours if a review is required.

6. Report templates

The system uses versioned templates to create consistent reports:

- Free AI Shortlist Snapshot
- Paid AI Shortlist Report

AI populates only defined fields in a structured report object. Ordinary application code inserts those fields into the templates and generates HTML/PDF.

Every claim about AI-search results must be supported by the stored prompt, response or cited source. Each report records:

- report-template version
- model used
- Auckland location setting
- run date and time
- source URLs and citations

The paid template contains:

1. Business and run details

2. What the website currently communicates
3. Likely buyer situations and supporting website evidence
4. Customer questions tested
5. AI-search results and competitor mentions
6. What the findings mean
7. Three prioritised actions, each linked to evidence
8. Results disclaimer
9. SuccessByCS next-step offer and contact method

7. Admin requirements

Provide a basic private admin webpage that reads live data from the database and shows:

- submitted domains
- business name
- email address
- free-report status
- payment status
- paid-report status
- generated ICP hypotheses
- generated question set
- notes
- report delivery date
- failed scan/job reason where applicable

Statuses:

- New
- Free report sent
- Payment started
- Paid
- Research in progress
- Report sent
- Human review required
- Closed

8. Data, privacy and support requirements

Store:

- domain URL

- email address
- business name
- service area
- generated website assessment
- ICP hypotheses and evidence excerpts
- generated question set
- consent timestamp, if marketing consent is given
- payment status
- report status
- paid-report findings
- Auckland date and time
- report-template version
- model/version and location setting
- citations and source URLs

Provide:

- a privacy page
- terms page
- a support contact email and contact form
- a way for a person to request deletion of their details

9. Out of scope for MVP

Do not build:

- a claim that the business has a fixed ChatGPT/OpenAI rank
- automated Google Business Profile changes
- automated website changes
- ongoing monthly monitoring
- client logins
- complicated dashboards
- multiple AI platforms
- a generic SEO platform
- additional industry verticals beyond Auckland landscapers/garden-maintenance businesses

10. Success measures

The first commercial success metrics are:

- 20 domain checks completed

- 10 email addresses captured
- 5 people click through to the paid offer
- 5 customers pay NZ\$47
- automated reports delivered within 10 minutes except for failures requiring review
- one customer agrees to an implementation conversation

11. MVP acceptance criteria

The MVP is ready when:

- A visitor can submit a valid public domain and see a meaningful preview.
- The preview includes a business summary, three buyer-situation hypotheses, one example question and three priority gaps.
- Each buyer-situation hypothesis shows supporting website evidence.
- A visitor can enter an email address and receive a free report.
- Marketing consent is optional and is recorded separately from report delivery.
- The email clearly offers the NZ\$47 full report.
- A successful payment creates a visible admin job.
- Each paid job stores the exact questions, responses, citations, model/version, location setting and run timestamp.
- The system generates the paid PDF from a versioned template.
- Failed scans and report jobs create an admin alert and a recoverable status.
- The webpage provides a way to contact the human admin.
- The experience works properly on mobile.

Email and report design discussion

USER

Mock up the email with the minimum report and the offer for the full report with the justification to buy the paid standard plan.

ASSISTANT

The email should be brief: a website summary, one verified strength or opportunity, then a clear reason the paid report is different - it tests what AI web search actually says across buyer questions.

USER

Needs to be short and concise.

ASSISTANT

Cut to one useful finding, one reason to upgrade, and one clear button.

USER

The advice given is bogus as the Green Gecko website does provide before and after photos under projects.

ASSISTANT

Correct. A report cannot make generic claims. It must cite the exact pages it assessed before recommending a change.

USER

They do: Green Gecko Gardens appears to provide residential landscaping, garden design and outdoor improvements for homeowners across Auckland's North Shore and nearby suburbs. In the email lets do a search for the key word and list the top 3 results if I asked this question of ChatGPT.

ASSISTANT

Use a natural buyer question rather than keywords. Show businesses surfaced in one dated AI-search response, whether the customer is mentioned, and sources where available. Do not call them a fixed ChatGPT ranking.

USER

What would the results of this search be and put it into the mock-up email.

ASSISTANT

For the mock, show Luijten Landscaping, Second Nature and The Plant People as businesses surfaced by the current broad web search. Mark it as a mock response. Production must execute the OpenAI web-search call at send time rather than inventing a ChatGPT result.

Evidence reviewed during the conversation

Green Gecko Gardens public website

The home page describes the business as Auckland-based landscaping specialists and lists landscaping, retaining walls, lawns, fencing and planting. It identifies the business as based in Henderson and serving North, East and West Auckland.

The Projects page is a material strength. It lists completed Auckland work at Ambrosia Avenue (Henderson), Gunson Street (Ponsonby), Knight Avenue (Mt Albert), Tapu Road (Huapai), Metcalfe Road (Ranui), Birkdale Road (Birkenhead) and Church Unlimited (Glendene).

Product rule adopted

The free and paid reports must distinguish what was found from what was inferred. Any improvement recommendation must carry page-level evidence or be worded as a question/hypothesis, not a confident

statement of absence.

Current broad web-search mock

For the natural-language sample question, current ordinary web search surfaced Luijten Landscaping, Second Nature and The Plant People. This is suitable only as illustrative mock data. The customer-facing product must obtain and store its own dated OpenAI web-search response.

Decisions to carry into build

- Brand: AI Shortlist by SuccessByCS.
- Initial domain: getaishortlist.successbycs.com.
- Primary market: Auckland small local service businesses, beginning with trades and home-service businesses.
- Free value: domain assessment plus one real, dated AI web-search sample - if the production system can execute it reliably.
- Paid Standard Report: NZ\$47 including GST; ten defined buyer questions; customer mention status; competitors and citations; three prioritised actions.
- Critical wording: a dated sample of AI web-search responses, not an official OpenAI ranking. Results may vary.
- Templates: model outputs structured fields and evidence; deterministic templates render the results webpage, email and PDF.
- Quality gate: never recommend a website change without supporting page-level evidence. Show strengths as well as gaps.
- Architecture direction: Cloudflare Worker/static web app with database, queue/workflow, PDF storage, Stripe, email delivery and protected private admin view.

End of transcript

This is a working product record. Before implementation, convert the final decisions into versioned requirements, field schemas, prompts, evaluations and acceptance tests in the project repository.